# Guidelines for 1st Trimester Pregnancy - 6 to 12 Week Diet

## Tips for Healthy Eating During the First Trimester

### 1. Portion Control

Use smaller plates to naturally reduce portion sizes while maintaining nutritional balance. Eat 3 balanced meals and 2-3 nourishing snacks per day (don't skip meals)

### 2. Staying Hydrated

Adequate hydration is essential during pregnancy, supporting nutrient transport, digestion, and amniotic fluid production.**Daily Hydration Goals: Drink 10- 12 glasses of water daily.**

### 3. Managing Morning Sickness Through Diet

Dietary Strategies for Nausea Relief:

Eat small, frequent meals every 2-3 hours to prevent an empty stomach. Add BRAT DIET In Morning meals like Banana with peanut butter, Apple with peanut butter , Toast with peanut butter.Ginger is evidence-supported for nausea relief: ginger tea (½ tsp grated), ginger candies.

**4. Managing Fatigue :** Iron deficiency is a major contributor to pregnancy fatigue. Address through diet and supplementation:Include iron-rich foods at every meal: lean red meat, poultry, fish, spinach, lentils, beansPair iron sources with Vitamin C (citrus, bell peppers, tomatoes) to enhance absorptionEat complex carbohydrates (oats, brown rice, whole grain bread) that provide steady energy without blood sugar spike.

**5. Managing Constipation : Pregnancy hormones slow digestion, but diet can help:**Increase fiber gradually: whole grains, fruits (pears, apples), vegetables (broccoli, carrots), legumes , Include healthy fats (olive oil, nuts) to lubricate the digestive tract

### 6. Meal Timing for Blood Sugar Stability

Eat breakfast within 1-2 hours of waking (helps prevent nausea and stabilizes energy), Space meals 3-4 hours apart, Include protein and fiber at every meal to maintain steady blood sugar, Avoid skipping meals, which can worsen nausea and fatigue

| Nutrient | Vegetarian Sources | Daily Target |
|---|---|---|
| Protein (60-70 g/day) | Paneer, yogurt, eggs, legumes (dal, chickpeas), tofu, nuts, seeds | Aim for 2-3 servings protein/day |
| Iron (27 mg/day) | Fortified cereals, spinach, lentils, chickpeas, pumpkin seeds, dried fruits | Include Vitamin C source (citrus, bell peppers) to enhance absorption |
| Calcium (1,000 mg/day) | Milk, yogurt, paneer, fortified plant-based milk, leafy greens (but note oxalates), almonds | Aim for 3-4 dairy/fortified servings/day |
| Vitamin B12 (2.6 mcg/day) | Dairy products, eggs, fortified plant-based milk, fortified cereals | Include one fortified source daily |
| Omega-3 (200-300 mg DHA/day) | Walnuts, flaxseeds, chia seeds, fortified milk, algae supplements | Include daily or take algae supplement |

**FOODS TO AVOID IN 6-12 WEEKS -**

Expectant mothers should avoid high-mercury fish, raw or undercooked seafood, undercooked meats, raw eggs, unpasteurized dairy, cold daily meats, and raw sprouts during early pregnancy. Additionally, products must be thoroughly washed, alcohol should be avoided entirely, and caffeine intake should be limited to under 200 mg per day.

# SAMPLE DIET PLAN FOR WEEK

| DAYS | Early Morning | Breakfast | Mid morning | Lunch | Evening Snack | Dinner | Bed Time |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Monday** | Warm lemon water + soaked almonds + walnuts - 5 pieces | Sprouts poha - 1 medium plate + Banana shake | Yoghurt with fruit and nuts/seeds topping | Roti - 2 medium + dal palak sabzi + curd + salad | Makhana cucumber salad or roasted chana chaat | Lentil and vegetable khichdi + curd + steamed veggies | Cinnamon milk with almonds and walnuts grinded |
| **Tuesday** | Ginger lemon tea + soaked almonds + walnuts -5 pieces | Scrambled egg omelette -2 with bread toast [multigrain or brown bread] | Coconut water +apple /banana/ oranges | Paneer or soya or egg roll - 2 medium pieces | Tea/coffee/ milk-1 cup with roasted soybean or paneer | Pesto Pasta with sauteed veggies | Cinnamon milk with almonds and walnuts grinded |
| **Wednesday** | Warm lemon water + soaked almonds + walnuts - 5 pieces | Paneer Sandwich -2 medium pieces + ABC Juice -150 ml [1 glass] | Yoghurt with fruit and nuts/seeds topping | Quinoa moong dal khichdi with steamed sauteed veggies and buttermilk -1 glass | Makhana cucumber salad or roasted chana chaat | Grilled chicken with steamed broccoli and Tomato or lemon coriander soup -1 bowl | Cinnamon milk with almonds and walnuts grinded |
| **Thursday** | Ginger lemon tea + soaked almonds + walnuts -5 pieces | Idli - 4 to 6 medium pieces + Mixed veg sambar -1 medium bowl | Coconut water +apple /banana/ oranges | Rajma /Chole/ Black chana /Chicken or egg curry with rice | Tea/coffee/ milk-1 cup with roasted soybean or paneer | Egg white dosa -2 + coconut chutney | Cinnamon milk with almonds and walnuts grinded |
| **Friday** | Warm lemon water + soaked almonds + walnuts - 5 pieces | Paneer or moong dal paratha -2 with curd | Yoghurt with fruit and nuts/seeds topping | Oats roti -2 + Mixed dal tadka + any seasonal vegetable + curd | Makhana cucumber salad or roasted chana chaat | Moong dal or besan oats chilla -2 with coconut chutney + 2 boiled egg white | Cinnamon milk with almonds and walnuts grinded |
| **Saturday** | Ginger lemon tea + soaked almonds + walnuts -5 pieces | Egg white dosa -2 + ABC Juice + coconut chutney | Coconut water +apple /banana/ oranges | Chicken or egg biryani + mixed veg raita | Tea/coffee/ milk-1 cup with roasted soybean or paneer | Mixed dal or Tur dal with Steamed rice + mixed veg salad | Cinnamon milk with almonds and walnuts grinded |
| **Sunday** | Warm lemon water + soaked almonds + walnuts - 5 pcs | Moong dal dosa with egg bhurji -2 dosa | Yoghurt with fruit and nuts/seeds topping | Oats roti -2 + Mixed dal tadka + any seasonal vegetable + | Makhana cucumber salad or roasted chana chaat | Wheat roti -2 + chicken/ fish curry + sauteed veggies | Cinnamon milk with almonds and walnuts grinded |

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